

Neue Sachlichkeit (New Objectivity)

Taking its name from an exhibition held in Mannheim in 1923, Neue Sachlichkeit was a German movement whose artists rejected contemporary avant-garde art and expressed its disillusionment with the world around them. Seeking to depict reality as they saw it, they made social commentaries in savage visual satires on the human condition. The two key artists were Otto Dix (1891–1969) and George Grosz (1893–1959): they graphically depicted corruption and hedonism of the ineffectual Weimar Republic that governed between the country's defeat in the First World War and the rise of the Nazi Party in 1933.

Two major trends emerged within the movement. The Verists, including Dix, Grosz and Max Pechstein (1884–1950), attacked the evils of society and depicted the devastating effects of the war. The Magic Realists, including Heinrich Maria Davringhausen (1894–1970) and Georg Schrimpf (1889–1938), aimed to counter the aggression and subjectivity of Expressionism by painting magical or unreal elements in otherwise ordinary environments.



Grosz, *Twilight*, 1922